



1 Ritu Kumar Home, the home décor range of fashion designer Ritu Kumar, offers wallpapers in two qualities—Royal Touch and Canvas textured

2 For Casa Pop that has been designing wallpapers for the last decade, it is about creating moods and spaces. They like to call it art by the metre

paint. “Wallpaper patterns cannot be recreated with paint unless it’s a mural or something. They are mostly used as a statement wall in different rooms,” says Gupta. “Also traditionally, labour has been cheap for us, so we are conditioned to getting the house repainted for Diwali. But that is changing now. A lot of nuclear families would just like to repaper a room on their own, experiment, and make it funky,” adds Gupta.

For nearly a decade, Asian Paints has had a range of wallpapers in collaboration with India’s leading fashion designer Sabyasachi Mukherjee. Called the ‘Nilaya’ range, its fourth and latest collection, titled ‘Paris-Calcutta’

décor range of fashion designer Ritu Kumar, has a series of wallpapers inspired by the sand dunes of Jaisalmer to the walls of Amer to the lush greenery of Kochi. These are offered in two qualities—Royal Touch and Canvas textured. Royal Touch is a smooth glossy paper, while Canvas is a matte textured base. At ₹350 per sq. ft, they come in standard sizes of 33 ft x 4ft and cover approximately 125 sq. ft of space.

There are several other brands, such as Sarita Handa, India Circus, Jaypore, etc. While India Circus is priced at ₹3,299 per sq. m, Jaypore sells pieces in a standard size of 4ft x 2 and a half ft, priced at ₹2,500 a piece. It has designs inspired by the African jungles, landscapes,

THE INDIAN WALLPAPER MARKET IS EXPECTED TO REACH \$783.3 MILLION BY 2032 FROM \$166.1 MILLION IN 2023

has over 30 wallpapers that range from large-scale damasks to re-interpreted kilims and paisleys. “Paris-Calcutta is a tale of two cities... One is the city that has consumed my imagination, the other is my home and eternal muse. With hand-painted motifs created by The Sabyasachi Art Foundation, this collection of wallpapers co-created with Asian Paints brings together the sophisticated artistry and cultural decadence of these two cities,” Mukherjee had said about the collection. For ₹30,800 a roll, which covers approximately 57 sq. ft, put this on your walls and let the conversations begin.

Ritu Kumar Home, the home

and riversides.

A wallpaper can transform a room from a basic living space to an elegant one. If you choose to instal the paper yourself, be patient when matching the pattern. Installation techniques include applying the paste on the back of the paper and then sticking it on the walls with the help of a wide brush to avoid bubbles. Some wallpapers come with a self-sticking adhesive, so they just need to be stuck like a sticker.

Today, wallpapers with their narrative qualities are setting the mood for a room. So go ahead and tell a story. **BT**

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